

Weekly Writing - Week 1

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1. Learning RStudio Independently vs. Using ChatGPT as a Tool

I believe students can be allowed to employ ChatGPT in RStudio but as a helping tool, not a cheat. Coding is intimidating, and wasting hours debugging trivial syntax issues sometimes takes away from learning more broad data analysis, visualization, and interpretation ideas. With ChatGPT, we can speed through repetition of errors faster and focus our energies on the skills that truly count. the exclusive use of ChatGPT would reduce our ability to code independently, which is a valuable skill in any case. Balance is best, using ChatGPT to describe errors or generating starting points but making sure that we understand the reasoning why the code is functional. In this manner we learn best both in coding and in high-level analysis.